Lesson notes · for you

Spot the scam

Cyber security · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
15 min

Materials
Paper and a pen; A phone, if you have one (yours, or a family phone with permission)

Learning goals

- Name the five warning signs of a scam.
- Recognise scams aimed at young people.
- Stop and check another way before you click, pay or share.
- Report, block and tell a trusted adult.

Activity: Scam or safe? cards

1. Write (6 min): On four small cards, write four short messages: two scams, each with at least one warning sign, and two safe messages, such as a match reminder or a library notice.
2. Swap (3 min): Shuffle your cards and swap them with a partner.
3. Judge (4 min): Sort your partner's cards into "scam" and "safe", and write the warning sign on each scam card.
4. Share (2 min): Together, choose the trickiest card and say what you would do if it reached your phone.

Never use real phone numbers, names or links on your cards.

Discussion

- Why do scammers use games and prizes?
- Why is a hurry a warning sign?
- Who could you ask before you pay online?

Check yourself

- One warning sign, and what I would do if I saw it.

Try it this week
Look through the messages on your phone, or a family phone with permission, and find one that shows a warning sign. Show it to someone at home and explain which sign gave it away.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A social media shop sells new phones at half price. You must pay by mobile money first, today only. What do you do?**

- ◯ Don't pay — it shows three warning signs
- ◯ Message the shop and ask if it's real
- ◯ Pay fast, before the offer ends

2 **If a message uses a real company's logo and has no spelling mistakes, it's safe.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Which of these are warning signs? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ A classmate telling you face to face about Saturday's match
- ☐ "Earn money fast: we'll send money through your account"
- ☐ A request for the code just sent to your phone
- ☐ Tomorrow's timetable, which you expected, from your school's saved number
- ☐ "Today only — pay now to keep your prize"

4 **Match each message to its warning sign.**

"10,000 free diamonds, just for you!"	• • • •	A hurry
"Pay before midnight or lose it"	• • • •	Too good to be true
"Send me the code you just got"	• • • •	The sender doesn't match
A "phone company" texting from a personal number	• • • •	Asks for a code

✎ **Think of a scam message you, a friend or someone in your family received. Which warning sign gave it away, or would have?**

Check your answers

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1 **Don't pay — it shows three warning signs**

A price far too low, payment first and a deadline are three warning signs together.

2 **False**

Scammers copy logos and write carefully, and some use AI tools to write perfect messages.

3 **"Today only — pay now to keep your prize"; A request for the code just sent to your phone; "Earn money fast: we'll send money through your account"**

"Today only, pay now" is a hurry plus a request for money.

4 **"10,000 free diamonds, just for you!" — Too good to be true**
"Pay before midnight or lose it" — A hurry
"Send me the code you just got" — Asks for a code
A "phone company" texting from a personal number — The sender doesn't match

Naming the sign helps you slow down, and helps you explain to friends and family why a message is a scam.